

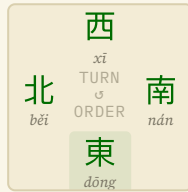
Setup 開局 *kāi jú*

How to seat, build the wall, break it with dice, and deal the opening 13 tiles.

01 · Seat

Choose the first dealer 莊家 *zhuāngjiā*

- Wash the tiles 洗牌 *xǐ pái* — place all 136 tiles face-down on the table and push them around in large circular motions until well shuffled.
 - Each player rolls 2 dice. The highest total takes the **East seat** 東 *dōng* and becomes the first dealer 莊家 *zhuāngjiā*. Ties re-roll between the tied players only.
- Play passes *counter-clockwise* to the **player on your right** — East → South → West → North → East ...

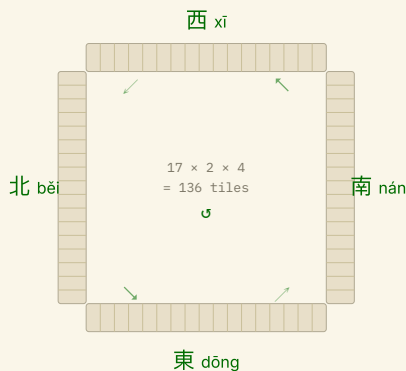


Mahjong seats are arranged opposite of a Western compass — **East** (the dealer) is at the bottom.

02 · Wall

Build the wall 築牆 *zhù qiáng*

- Each player builds a row of tiles in front of them: **17 stacks long × 2 tiles high**, face-down. Push all four walls together to form a hollow square in the center of the table.
- $17 \times 2 \times 4 \text{ sides} = 136 \text{ tiles} \checkmark$



03 · Break

Break the wall 開門 *kāi mén*

- The dealer rolls 2 dice. The total does *two things at once* — it picks **whose wall** to break and **where on it** to break.

 = **8** (example)

① **Whose wall?** Counting counter-clockwise from East = 1 (E → S → W → N).

東 *dōng* East 1 · 5 · 9

南 *nán* South 2 · 6 · 10

西 *xī* West 3 · 7 · 11

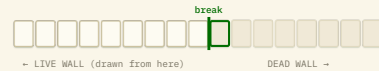
北 *běi* North 4 · 8 · 12

Total of **8** → **North**. Break that wall.

② **Where on it?** Count the dice total in stacks from the right end of that wall.

Tiles to the **left** of the break = **live wall** (drawn from). Tiles to the **right** = **dead wall**.

NORTH WALL · BREAK AT STACK 8 FROM THE RIGHT



04 · Deal

Deal the tiles 發牌 *fā pái*

- Starting from the break point, players take turns grabbing **4 tiles at a time**, going *counter-clockwise* (E → S → W → N).

After three rounds each player has **12 tiles**. Each takes **1 more** → 13 tiles. Finally the dealer takes one extra → **14 tiles**, then discards one to start play.

DEALER'S OPENING HAND · 14 TILES



OTHER THREE PLAYERS · 13 TILES EACH



Rules

Wall & round mechanics

Dead wall

The last **14 tiles** of the wall (to the right of the break) are reserved for Gàng replacements — never drawn in regular play.

Dealer rotation

The dealer keeps the East seat *as long as they keep winning*. When any other player wins, the deal passes *counter-clockwise* — South becomes East, West becomes South, and so on.

Gàng replacement

When a player declares a 杠 *gàng* (4 of a kind), they draw **one extra tile** from the end of the dead wall to keep their hand at 14 → discard.

Drawn hand 荒莊 *huāng zhuāng*

If the live wall empties with no winner, the round is a draw — no payouts and the dealer keeps East.